A New Short Film Joins My Chemical Romance's World

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Artist Lauren Tsai has made a new short film with the band My Chemical Romance. The film is called **Prelude** to The End. It continues the story of Astrid, a character from Tsai's dream world, The Dying World. Tsai first shared that world in a short film last year. As a kid, she made **animated** fan videos for the band's songs, so working with them now feels like a full circle. The film uses the first song from the band's album The Black Parade, called The End. It comes just after the release of The Black Parade (20th Anniversary). The film will be shown before the band's last shows at the Hollywood Bowl on Oct. 30 and 31. In the story, Astrid goes to a strange **boarding school** in New England that is full of trash. When school leaders throw her beloved **sketchbook** down a **chute**, she follows it into a world of forgotten ideas. There she meets an old friend. Tsai also voices Astrid. Billie Eilish voices Astrid's friend, and Phoebe Bridgers voices her sister.

Word Treasure

Prelude -- An opening part that comes before the main story or piece of music.

boarding school -- A school where pupils live during term time instead of going home each day.

sketchbook -- A book for drawing pictures and ideas in.

chute -- A narrow slide or passage that things drop down through.

animated -- Made with moving drawings or computer pictures instead of filmed real people.

Background you need

A short film is a brief movie that tells one story in much less time than a full-length film.

Musicians sometimes work with artists to build a story world around their songs, with characters and places that carry across films and shows.

Lauren Tsai's dream world follows Astrid, and this new film continues her story as she follows her sketchbook into a world of forgotten ideas.

Break it down

WHO: Artist Lauren Tsai, the band My Chemical Romance, and voice actors Billie Eilish and Phoebe Bridgers, with the character Astrid

WHAT: Tsai made a new short film, Prelude to The End, continuing Astrid's story from The Dying World

WHERE: Before the band's last shows at the Hollywood Bowl, with the story set at a strange boarding school in New England

WHY: The film continues the story Tsai first shared last year and uses the first song from The Black Parade, coming just after its anniversary release

Why it matters

It shows that a hobby you start as a kid, like making fan videos, can one day grow into working with the artists you admire.

Test what you remember

1. What is the new short film called?

(A) The End
(B) The Black Parade
(C) The Dying World
(D) Prelude to The End

2. Who made the film with My Chemical Romance?

(A) Astrid
(B) Phoebe Bridgers
(C) Lauren Tsai
(D) Billie Eilish

3. What did Lauren Tsai make as a kid for the band's songs?

(A) Posters for their concerts
(B) Animated fan videos
(C) A school musical
(D) A comic book series

4. Where will the film be shown?

(A) At Astrid's boarding school
(B) On a television news show
(C) Before the band's last shows at the Hollywood Bowl
(D) In a museum in New England

5. What happens to Astrid's sketchbook in the story?

(A) School leaders throw it down a chute
(B) Her friend borrows it
(C) She gives it to her sister
(D) It is lost in a storm

6. Who voices Astrid's friend and her sister?

(A) My Chemical Romance voice them both
(B) Billie Eilish voices her friend and Phoebe Bridgers voices her sister
(C) Lauren Tsai voices both
(D) Phoebe Bridgers voices her friend and Billie Eilish voices her sister

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: C 3: B 4: C 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Lauren Tsai: Feels that working with the band now is like a full circle, because she made animated fan videos for their songs as a kid.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):